

George Kachergis, Ph.D.

Senior Data Scientist

TransUnion, Inc.

george.kachergis@gmail.com

<https://kachergis.com>

Education & Professional Experience

- 2024–present: Senior Data Scientist in fraud detection, TransUnion, Inc.
- Fall 2024: Research Scholar, PI of Computational Cognitive Models Lab, Arizona State University
- 2022–2024: Lead Research Scientist, Skillprint, created ontology of games; designed, ran, and analyzed game-based mood interventions
- 2018–2022: Research Scientist, Language and Cognition Lab, PI: Michael C. Frank, Stanford University
- 2016–2018: Assistant Professor, Department of Artificial Intelligence and Donders Institute for Brain, Cognition, and Behaviour, Radboud University
- 2015–2016: Postdoctoral Researcher on active sensemaking, New York University, PIs: Todd Gureckis and Marjorie Rhodes, Varieties of Understanding Project
- 2013–2014: Postdoctoral Researcher on knowledge representation, Leiden University, Advisor: Bernhard Hommel, RoboHow Project
- 2012: Ph.D. Indiana University, Cognitive Science & Department of Psychological and Brain Sciences. Advisors: Richard M. Shiffrin and Chen Yu.
- 2007: B.A. Computer Science & Cognitive Studies, Carleton College, *Magna cum laude*

Selected Awards

- **Diversity and Social Inequality Award, Cognitive Science Society, 2022**
- **Robert J. Glushko Dissertation Prize** for outstanding interdisciplinary work (\$10,000), 2013
- **Marr Prize for Best Student Paper, Cognitive Science Society, 2012**

Selected Publications

1. **Kachergis, G.** and Austerweil, J. L. *Video games as a path to a contextualized cognitive science, or how to move beyond 20 questions with nature*. Workshop presented at the 45th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society. Website: <https://www.games4understanding.com/>
2. Frank, M. C., Baumgartner, H., Braginsky, M., **Kachergis, G.**, ..., Cubillo, A. (2025). Learning Variability Network Exchange (LEVANTE): A global framework for measuring children’s learning variability through collaborative data sharing. *Child Development*. doi: 10.1111/cdev.70011

3. Tamis-LeMonda, **Kachergis, G.**, ..., Yurovsky, D. (2024). *Comparing apples to manzanas and oranges to naranjas: A new measure of English-Spanish vocabulary for dual language learners*. *Infancy*. doi: 10.1111/inf.12571
4. Bang, J. Y., **Kachergis, G.**, Weisleder, A., and Marchman, V. A. *An automated classifier for periods of sleep and target-child-directed speech from LENA recordings*. *Language Development Research*.
5. **Kachergis, G.***, Tan, A. W. M.*, Marchman, V. A., Dale, P. S., and Frank, M. C. (2023). *Measuring children’s early vocabulary in low-resource languages using a Swadesh-style word list*. *Proc. of the 45th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*.
6. **Kachergis, G.**, Francis, N., and Frank, M. C. (2022). *Estimating demographic bias on tests of children’s early vocabulary*. *Topics in Cognitive Science*.
7. Zettersten, M., Yurovsky, D., ..., **Kachergis, G.**, ... Bergey, C. A., and Frank, M. C. (2022). *Peekbank: An open, large-scale repository for developmental eye-tracking data of children’s word recognition*. *Behavior Research Methods*. doi: 10.3758/s13428-022-01906-4.
8. Tsui, A. S. M., Carstensen, A., **Kachergis, G.**, ..., Frank, M. C. (2025). *Exploring variation in infants’ preference for infant-directed speech: Evidence from a multi-site study in Africa*. *Developmental Science*. Preprint: <https://osf.io/fqp4b>
9. Long, B., **Kachergis, G.**, Agrawal, K., and Frank, M. C. (2022). *A longitudinal analysis of the social information in infants’ naturalistic visual experience using automated detections*. *Developmental Psychology*. Preprint: <https://psyarxiv.com/z7tdg/>
10. **Kachergis, G.**, Marchman, V. A., Dale, P., Mankewitz, J., Frank, M. C. (2022). *An Online Computerized Adaptive Test (CAT) of Children’s Vocabulary Development in English and Mexican Spanish*. *Journal of Speech, Language, and Hearing Research*. Preprint: <https://psyarxiv.com/5ftsu>
11. **Kachergis, G.**, Marchman, V. A., and Frank, M. C. (2022). *Toward a “Standard Model” of Early Language Learning*. *Current Directions in Psychological Science*. doi: 10.1177/09637214211057836
12. **Kachergis, G.** (2018). *Word learning: Associations or hypothesis testing?* *Current Biology*. 28(9), R555–R557. doi: 10.1016/j.cub.2018.02.077.
13. **Kachergis, G.**, Rhodes, M., and Gureckis, T. (2017). *Desirable difficulties in the development of active inquiry skills*. *Cognition*. 166, 407–417. doi: 10.1016/j.cognition.2017.05.021.
14. **Kachergis, G.** and Yu, C. (2017). *Observing and modeling developing knowledge and uncertainty during cross-situational word learning*. *IEEE Transactions on Cognitive and Developmental Systems*. 10(2), 227–236. doi: 10.1109/TCDS.2017.2735540.
15. **Kachergis, G.**, Yu, C., and Shiffrin, R. M. (2016). *A bootstrapping model of frequency and contextual diversity effects in word learning*. *Cognitive Science*. 41(3), 590–622. doi: 10.1111/cogs.12353.
16. **Kachergis, G.**, Yu, C., and Shiffrin, R. M. (2014). *Cross-situational word learning is both implicit and strategic*. *Frontiers in Cognitive Science*. doi: 10.3389/fpsyg.2014.00588